

Problem Discovery & User Research

AtliQ Sales & CRM Memory Assistant

Learner Name	Aishwarya Odhala
Project Name	AtliQ Sales & CRM Memory Assistant (Capstone 1)

Pain Point

Bhavin · Co-founder — his own email, and what happened next

On 30 March, replying to FinEdge Bank's compliance team: “Suresh — all three documents attached. Data residency confirmed: all environments hosted in-region, no offshore replication. Let me know if compliance needs anything else.”

Three months later, per the thread's own record: compliance had cleared, and the client asked to schedule the commercial discussion. There was still no reply — not because Bhavin doesn't follow through, but because nothing surfaced it back to him once the email left his outbox.

Voice of the Client — From Our Kickoff Conversation

Karandeep's words below come directly from our kickoff conversation. Bhavin's and Jay's come directly from their own real emails and notes in this project's dataset — quoted, not invented.

Karandeep CEO	“The proposal was genuinely ready — I just held it back because I was waiting on a confirmation. By the time I sent it, it looked like I'd been sitting on it the whole time.”
	“Even with everything sitting in my head, I couldn't hand someone a clear picture before I left for leave — the information was scattered across so many places that explaining it myself would've been faster than writing it down.”
Bhavin Co-founder	From his own FinEdge Bank email, 30 March: “All three documents attached... let me know if compliance needs anything else.” Thorough, professional, complete. The thread's own record shows no reply after — even once the client came back three months later, ready to move forward.
Jay Sales Executive	From his own meeting note on BlueOrchid Hotels, 19 June, after promising to follow up: “...need her email first, it's on her card. which card. which drawer.”

A) Persona

Primary user: Bhavin — Co-founder

Bhavin is profiled in depth below as the named primary persona, but this reality is shared day-to-day by Karandeep as CEO — both carry the weight of being founder-level decision-makers with no dedicated time to keep the CRM honest.

Co-founder of AtliQ Technologies, splitting time between running the company and personally closing deals. Owns several of the pipeline's highest-value, most time-sensitive leads (e.g. FinEdge Bank at ~\$95,000, NovaPharma at ~\$80,000). Sales is one of several hats he wears in a given week, alongside operations — there is no dedicated block of time set aside to keep the CRM honest.

Goals

1	Close high-value deals without losing momentum during long sales cycles.
2	Know at a glance which relationships genuinely need attention this week, without re-reading every email thread.
3	Trust that nothing important — a client's question, a compliance requirement, a looming deadline — is quietly falling through the cracks.
4	Hand a lead off to a colleague (e.g. while on leave) without that person starting from zero.

✿ *Bhavin doesn't need another dashboard — he needs to trust the one he already has.* ✿

Pain Points

1	Critical updates (a compliance review clearing, a board decision date) live in email threads and never make it into the CRM — so the record looks stale even while the deal is actually moving forward.
2	There is no time between selling and running the company to manually update every lead after every call or email exchange.
3	Two people can each have a genuine, good-faith conversation with the same prospect — a founder and Jay, say — and neither finds out until later, simply because there's no shared view of who's already spoken to whom. Not carelessness; everyone is juggling multiple live deals at once with no spare time to cross-check before every call.
4	When a colleague is unreachable (travel, leave), whoever picks up their leads inherits a thin CRM record and has to reconstruct context from scattered emails.

Behaviour

1	Skims the inbox for anything urgent between meetings, rather than working through the CRM systematically.
2	Updates the CRM in batches, days after a conversation happened, reconstructing details from memory.
3	Relies on knowing the pipeline “in his head” rather than trusting the CRM as a single source of truth.

Success Metric

1	Time from “an insight appears in an email” to “that insight is reflected in a follow-up action” shrinks from weeks to days.
2	Fewer high-value leads sit untouched past 30 days despite real client engagement.
3	Reported confidence (self-rated) that nothing important is being missed increases.

Secondary persona: Jay — Sales Executive

AtliQ's one dedicated salesperson, handling a higher volume of earlier-stage leads than the founders: cold outreach (ApexAuto Parts), conference contacts (TechSummit Mumbai alone produced 15+ cards in one day), and inbound intros (SmartServe Hospitality, Vertex Constructions, UrbanNest Realty, SteelCore Industries). He's genuinely diligent on the first touch — pricing sent the same week, objections answered thoughtfully and specifically. The pattern across his own leads is what happens after: once a client goes quiet, nothing brings that lead back to his attention.

Goals	• Get promising leads past the first reply into a real second follow-up, not just an initial response. • Know immediately if a founder is already talking to the same company. • Not lose a lead simply because its contact details only ever existed on a business card.
Pain Points	• A strong first response, then silence — nothing resurfaces a stalled lead once the week fills up. (<i>Vertex Constructions L-1037, SteelCore Industries L-1021, UrbanNest Realty — same pattern, three separate leads.</i>) • Conference leads arrive faster than they can be worked. (<i>TechSummit Mumbai: 15+ cards collected, “8–10 more in the drawer, not yet gone through” — Karandeep himself predicted “half of these will go cold.”</i>) • Real CRM gaps block follow-up before it can even start. (<i>ApexAuto Parts L-1028: no owner assigned. BlueOrchid Hotels L-1006: no contact email captured, despite a serious conversation.</i>) • No shared view of who's already talking to whom, even in good faith. (<i>Meridian Healthcare — Jay connected with Sanjay at TechSummit, not knowing Bhavin already had a proposal in progress.</i>)

B) Empathy Map: What They...

THINKS	FEELS
“Did I already reply to this? What exactly did they ask for? I know this deal is close, but I can't remember what's actually blocking it.”	Mild guilt and quiet anxiety — aware that things are slipping, but no time built into the day to fix the system itself; frustration when a client references something that was never logged.
SAYS	DOES
“I'll update the CRM later.” · “Let me check my email for that.” · “I thought we already sent that.”	Scans the inbox for urgent flags between meetings; relies on memory for deal context; updates the CRM in a weekly batch, if at all; occasionally ends up in a duplicate conversation with a colleague's lead — not from carelessness, but because there's no shared view of who's already talking to whom.

✿ *The guilt isn't about being careless — it's about not having a system that remembers for him.* ✿

C) 5 Whys

Why #1 <i>Possible answer:</i>	Why do deals go cold or get missed?
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	Follow-ups don't happen on time, even on deals that are actually progressing.
Why #2 <i>Possible answer:</i>	Why don't follow-ups happen on time? The founders don't always know a follow-up is due — the CRM doesn't reflect the real state of the conversation.
Why #3 <i>Possible answer:</i>	Why doesn't the CRM reflect the real state of the conversation? The details that matter (a cleared compliance review, a rescheduled board date, a client's specific question) live in emails and meeting notes, not in CRM fields.
Why #4 <i>Possible answer:</i>	Why don't those details make it into the CRM? Manually transcribing every conversation into the CRM takes time nobody has between selling and running the company.
Why #5 <i>Possible answer:</i>	Why is there no time for this? Sales is founder-led — the same few people are simultaneously closing deals and operating the business, so CRM upkeep is always the first thing sacrificed.

Actual Problem Statement (Root Cause)

The CRM only captures what a busy deal owner remembers to manually type in — everything else, the real signals that indicate a deal's true status, lives scattered across emails and meeting notes with nothing connecting it back to the CRM. Revenue leaks not from a lack of leads, but from a lack of memory.

Proposed Solution

An AI-powered memory layer that sits underneath the CRM — reading the CRM export, emails, and meeting notes together, and surfacing (never silently editing) where they disagree, what's missing, what's time-sensitive, and what's been asked but never answered. Every finding is traceable to its original source text, and every suggested action requires human approval before anything changes — so founders act on real signals instead of hunting for them across scattered sources.

D) Job To Be Done

Job To Be Done	When I sit down to check my pipeline, or before a client call, help me see every unresolved signal about that relationship — across CRM, email, and notes — in one place, so I can follow up with confidence instead of reconstructing the deal's history from memory.
Why worth solving	Today, catching up on a single deal's real status means manually re-reading email threads and meeting notes — slow and error-prone, and usually skipped given time pressure. When it's skipped, deals with real signals (a cleared compliance review, an answered objection, a looming board decision) go stale or get missed entirely, directly costing revenue — e.g. a \$95,000 deal (FinEdge Bank) sat untouched for weeks after the client was actually ready to proceed.
Why AI may help	Early hypothesis: reading and cross-referencing unstructured text (emails, notes) against structured CRM data, at the volume and speed needed, isn't realistic to do

	manually for every lead every week. A language model can extract and compare this reliably if strictly grounded in the source documents — with every output traceable back to evidence rather than trusted blindly. Pressure-tested further in the AI PRD.
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✿ *One source of truth — so no relationship depends on any one person's memory alone.* ✿

Bhavin, Karandeep, and Jay's voices carry through every deliverable in this submission — the same people, the same real pain points, from problem to prototype to pitch.